

Setup Instructions

How to run the Ambula Healthcare Platform locally.

Prerequisites

Node.js	v20.x or higher (required by Vite 8)
npm	v9+ (bundled with Node)
MongoDB	Atlas cluster — connection string in .env
Git	Any recent version

Step 1 — Clone the repository

```
git clone https://github.com/suchitha02/ambula_healthcare_platform.git
cd ambula_healthcare_platform
```

Step 2 — Backend setup

```
cd ambula/backend
npm install

# Seed sample doctors and slots
node scripts/seed.js

# Start the server (default port 5000)
npm start
```

Backend .env variables

PORT	5000
MONGO_URI	Your MongoDB Atlas connection string
JWT_SECRET	ambula_jwt_secret_key_2025_secure_xyz
JWT_EXPIRY	15m
REFRESH_TOKEN_SECRET	ambula_refresh_secret_key_2025_abc
REFRESH_TOKEN_EXPIRY	7d
FRONTEND_URL	http://localhost:5173 (Vercel URL in prod)

CLOUDINARY_*

Optional — only for image upload features

Step 3 — Frontend setup

```
cd ../frontend
npm install

# .env file contents
VITE_API_URL=http://localhost:5000/api
VITE_SOCKET_URL=http://localhost:5000

# Start dev server (port 5173)
npm run dev
```

Step 4 — Open in browser

Frontend: **http://localhost:5173**
Backend API: **http://localhost:5000/api**